

# PassportSahayak AI

Knowledge Base Document

## Application Status, Grievance & Appeals

Status Tracking, Grievance Channels, Rejection Appeals & Fraud Reporting

|                   |                                                               |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Category          | Grievance & Appeals                                           |
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# 1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines the application status tracking process, grievance redressal channels and SLAs, rejection appeal procedures, fraud reporting mechanisms, and the applicant's rights under the Citizens' Charter. It is the primary reference for applicants whose applications are delayed, rejected, or disputed, and for PSK/RPO officials routing grievances.

## 2. Application Status Tracking

### 2.1 Status Tracking via ApplicationStatusTool

Applicants and officials can retrieve real-time application status by providing the ARN. The ApplicationStatusTool queries the Passport Seva Portal and returns the current status.

| Status                | Description                                             | Applicant Next Step                             |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Application Submitted | Online form submitted; ARN generated; payment confirmed | Book PSK appointment                            |
| Appointment Booked    | Appointment confirmed at selected PSK/POPSK             | Prepare documents per KB-PASS-002               |
| PSK Visit Completed   | Application accepted at counter; documents verified     | Wait for PV dispatch confirmation               |
| PV Dispatched         | PV request sent to police; home visit pending           | Ensure availability at registered address       |
| PV In Progress        | Home visit done; report under compilation               | No action required                              |
| PV Cleared            | Satisfactory PV report received                         | Passport being printed and dispatched           |
| Passport Dispatched   | Passport sent via Speed Post                            | Track via Speed Post tracking number            |
| Passport Delivered    | Delivery confirmed by Speed Post                        | Collect from post office if delivery was missed |
| On Hold               | Issue requiring applicant response                      | Contact RPO or PSK immediately; 30-day window   |
| Rejected              | Application rejected after review                       | Initiate appeal per Section 4                   |

### 2.2 Status Tracking Channels

| Channel                                     | How to Use                                         | Availability           |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| PassportSahayak AI — ApplicationStatusTool  | Provide ARN to the AI assistant                    | 24x7                   |
| Passport Seva Portal (passportindia.gov.in) | Login → Track Application Status → Enter ARN       | 24x7                   |
| mPassport Seva Mobile App                   | Login → Check Status                               | 24x7                   |
| PSK Helpline: 1800-258-1800                 | Call with ARN ready                                | Mon–Sat, 8 AM – 10 PM  |
| SMS Status Request                          | SMS 'STATUS ' to 9704100100                        | 24x7                   |
| RPO Walk-in                                 | Visit RPO with original documents and ARN printout | Weekdays, 10 AM – 4 PM |

## 3. Grievance Redressal System

### 3.1 Grievance Channel SLA Matrix

The following matrix defines official grievance channels, applicable situations, and SLAs mandated under the Citizens' Charter for Passport Services.

| Grievance Type                                     | Primary Channel                                              | SLA                       | Escalation                               |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Application status delay (>30 days from PSK visit) | Passport Seva Portal → Grievance → Lodge Complaint with ARN  | 7 working days            | RPO Grievance Cell → Joint Secretary CPV |
| PV delay beyond 30 working days                    | Passport Seva Portal Grievance or PSK Helpline 1800-258-1800 | 5 working days            | RPO → SP Office follow-up via CCTNS      |
| Incorrect rejection at counter                     | PSK Manager → RPO Grievance Cell within 7 days               | 10 working days           | RPO Deputy Passport Officer (DPO)        |
| Passport dispatched but not received               | Speed Post tracking → India Post complaint → RPO             | 7 working days            | RPO re-dispatch order                    |
| PSK staff misconduct / bribery demand              | PSK Feedback form + PGPortal.gov.in                          | 15 working days           | CVC / ACB referral (see KB-PASS-007)     |
| Police officer demanding payment for PV            | PSK helpline 1800-258-1800 + PGPortal                        | 3 working days (priority) | CVC / State ACB referral                 |
| Data entry error in passport                       | RPO Data Correction Counter + written request                | 7 working days            | RPO Senior Officer review                |

## 3.2 Citizens' Charter SLA Table

The following SLAs are guaranteed under the Citizens' Charter for Passport Services issued by the Ministry of External Affairs.

| Service                            | SLA                                                       |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Fresh Passport — Normal (Post-PV)  | 30 working days from date of PSK visit                    |
| Fresh Passport — Normal (Pre-PV)   | 30 working days from date PV clearance is received by RPO |
| Re-issue Passport — Normal         | 30 working days from PSK visit date                       |
| Tatkal Passport (Post-PV)          | 3 working days from PSK visit date                        |
| Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) | 10 working days                                           |
| Police Verification Report         | 30 working days from dispatch to SP office                |
| Grievance Resolution               | 7–15 working days depending on grievance type             |
| RTI Response                       | 30 calendar days as per RTI Act 2005                      |

**SLA BREACH:** If the SLA is breached, file a grievance immediately through the Passport Seva Portal. SLA-breach cases are auto-flagged and must be escalated via EscalationTool by PSK/RPO officials.

## 4. Rejection & Appeal Procedure

### 4.1 Grounds for Rejection

- Incomplete or incorrect documentation
- Adverse police verification report
- Pending criminal case or court proceedings (depending on nature of offence)
- Suppression of material information in the application
- Suspected fraudulent documents or identity
- Pending visa/travel restrictions as per MEA/court order
- Applicant declared a Proclaimed Offender (PO)

## 4.2 Appeal Authority Chain

| Level          | Appeal Authority                               | Grounds                                                   | Timeline                           |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Level 1        | Deputy Passport Officer (DPO) at RPO           | Documentation issues, minor data errors, address mismatch | Within 30 days of rejection        |
| Level 2        | Passport Officer at RPO                        | Adverse PV report, PV-related rejection, re-verification  | Within 30 days of Level 1 decision |
| Level 3        | Regional Passport Officer (RPO Head)           | PV irreversibility, policy interpretation disputes        | Within 30 days of Level 2 decision |
| Level 4        | Joint Secretary (CPV Division), MEA, New Delhi | All remaining grounds; final appellate authority          | Within 60 days of Level 3 decision |
| Legal Recourse | High Court / Supreme Court (Writ Petition)     | Constitutional right to travel; mandamus writ             | As per court procedures            |

## 4.3 Appeal Process — Step by Step

| Step | Action                                                                                  |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Receive rejection order from RPO in writing (states reason and appeal authority)        |
| 2    | Prepare response addressing the rejection grounds with supporting documents             |
| 3    | Submit written appeal to Level 1 authority (DPO) within 30 days of rejection order      |
| 4    | RPO schedules personal hearing if required (applicant may bring a legal representative) |
| 5    | DPO issues written decision within 15 working days                                      |
| 6    | If rejected at Level 1 — escalate to Level 2 (Passport Officer) within 30 days          |
| 7    | EscalationTool is invoked at each escalation step to route the case with full context   |

**ADVISORY:** PassportSahayak AI provides only procedural guidance on how criminal/court cases may affect passport applications. It does not predict outcomes. All such cases are escalated via EscalationTool to the RPO for case-specific review. The applicant should also consult a legal professional.

## 5. Fraud Reporting

Fraudulent passport applications are prosecutable under the Passports Act 1967 and IPC. Citizens and PSK officials are encouraged to report any suspected fraud.

| Fraud Type                             | Reporting Channel                       | Outcome                                                      |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forged documents in application        | PSK Manager → RPO → Police              | Application cancelled; FIR filed; blacklisted in MEA system  |
| Impersonation at PSK                   | PSK Staff → PSK Manager → Police        | Application cancelled; security footage preserved; FIR filed |
| Agent/broker demanding payment         | PGPortal.gov.in + PSK helpline          | CVC / ACB referral; agent blacklisted from PSK premises      |
| Duplicate/multiple passport fraud      | RPO → MEA Intelligence Division         | Both passports impounded; criminal proceedings initiated     |
| Online phishing / fake Passport portal | CERT-In (cert-in.org.in) + cyber police | Fraudulent site reported; applicant alerted via MEA advisory |

## 6. Document Control

|                        |                                                                       |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
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